



Grade K Social Studies

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · KINDERGARTEN · FULL YEAR

160 min per week · 2 lessons weekly

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in sources, activities, and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Kindergarten Social Studies invites young scholars to explore meaningful questions about themselves, their families, and their communities through foundational concepts in history, geography, civics, and economics, building a big-picture understanding of people and places over time. Through stories, pictures, maps, and careful observation, scholars begin to sequence events, identify the roles and responsibilities of community members, recognize cultural symbols and traditions, and understand rules and maps in their world. The course gathers around the theme Living, Learning and Working Together, and the seven Optima virtues connect to the people and habits scholars study throughout the year.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 History (strand)

Using timelines and calendars to understand time and sequence, becoming aware of primary sources and historical figures, comparing families, holidays, and cultures past and present, and identifying U.S. and Florida symbols.

2 Geography (strand)

Using maps, globes, and positional words; identifying cardinal directions, locations, landforms, and bodies of water; and locating places in the school and community.

3 Economics (strand)

Identifying jobs and the tools people use, recognizing that people work to earn money, learning the forms of money, and telling the difference between basic needs and wants.

4 Civics (strand)

Understanding rules, laws, and authority figures; practicing good citizenship and group decision making; and recognizing patriotism and national and state symbols.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Two social studies lessons each week.
- The first builds background through stories, pictures, maps, and guided observation.
- The second is applied work such as map activities, sequencing events, role-play, or notebook narration.
- The seven Optima virtues connect to the people and habits scholars study throughout the year.

TIME COMMITMENT

160 minutes / week

two lessons a week, about 80 minutes each

- Each week pairs one background lesson with one applied lesson.
- Project and exhibition weeks may run a little longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A notebook for drawings, narrations, and simple maps.
- Crayons or colored pencils and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- An adult to support young learners (especially in Kindergarten).

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting twice a week on the school's weekly schedule.